

your kids those three basic principles, they'll leave the house at 18 with their very own MBA.

Money Mistake: *Your Kids Don't Know Much About Money*

The Fix: *Give Them an MBA: Money & Banking Awareness*

Any good teacher will tell you that young children learn best if you can make the lessons practical—hence why preschool math classes do so much counting on fingers. If you want to give your children an MBA—the Money and Banking Awareness they'll come to rely on as financially literate adults—you must flesh out every financial concept with a tangible lesson. You want your kids to see *why* saving and investing money is worthwhile, and to feel profit and loss for themselves.

To help parents teach their kids about money, I've created a Cash Curriculum for children ages five to 14. I suggest tying each financial lesson to a birthday, for several reasons. A child's birthday is a momentous occasion, and money is the lifeblood of momentous occasions. Birthdays have special value for a family, and you want to imbue these financial lessons with the same kind of intrinsic value. If you can make the money lesson a part of the celebration, your son or daughter will begin to understand that financial literacy can be fun. I've addressed the following age-based advice to a daughter but it works equally well for a son.

CASH CURRICULUM FOR AGES 5–14

Age 5

Bank Day

A week before your child's fifth birthday, tell her you need help with one of her presents. It's up to you whether you confess what you're up to or keep it a surprise, but here's the gist: she's going to create a Money Bin.

The Money Bin can be a jar, bag, pot or pouch—whatever gets your child excited. If your son is into pottery, perfect: have him